INCLUDED WITH YOUR PURCHASE

The Research Basis

Every source behind The Move-Out Blueprint

218 sources, each with a verification tier — including the places where the evidence is weaker than the popular claim.

Why this document exists

Most guides in this category cite nothing. You are asked to trust the author.

This one is built on **218 sources** — federal agencies, peer-reviewed research, and major research institutions — and every factual claim in either edition carries a bracketed reference to a numbered row in the list that follows.

Three things make this list unusual, and they are the reason it is worth reading:

1 · Every source carries a verification tier. A figure from a federal agency and a figure from a commercial vendor are not equally reliable, and this document says which is which rather than blending them into an undifferentiated wall of citations.

2 · There is a section on weak evidence. Part 13 records the places where the research came back weaker than the popular claim — including one case where the advice in an earlier draft of this book had to be softened, and one federal statistic that was corrected downward in 2025. That section is in here on purpose. A guide that only tells you what is convenient is not worth trusting.

3 · The mechanisms are evidenced, not the product. Nobody has run a controlled trial on "does reading a move-out guide work." That study does not exist, and any product claiming otherwise is misleading you. What is evidenced — heavily — are the specific mechanisms the book is built on: if-then planning, automatic transfers, commitment devices, separated and labelled accounts, checklists, and structured financial education. **Part 1 of this list is that evidence**, and it is the part most worth your time.

The honest limitation

This library was compiled through systematic search rather than by reading every source document end to end. That is why the tier column exists, and why A-tier and C-tier are clearly separated.

Tier A — named primary institution reporting its own figure. **Tier B** — reputable secondary source reporting a named primary study. **Tier C** — industry or aggregator figure; treat as a range, never a precise fact.

marks figures that go stale within about twelve months — rent, food costs and survey data especially.

If you are going to rely on a specific number for a significant financial decision, follow the citation and check it yourself. That is what the list is for.

Source Library — The Move-Out Blueprint

218 sources. Compiled September 2026.

Breakdown by verification tier: **69 A-tier** (named primary institution), **105 B-tier** (reputable secondary reporting a named primary), **39 C-tier** (industry/aggregator, use as ranges only), plus 5 entries recording where the evidence is weaker than the popular claim.

Every substantive claim in either edition traces to a numbered row here. This file is the master. The buyer-facing version is `../sales/research-basis.md`.

How to read the verification column

I could not open source pages directly while building this — the build environment blocked all outbound fetching except a search API. So every row carries an honest verification tier. **Read this before you put a number on a sales page.**

TIER	MEANING	SAFE TO QUOTE PUBLICLY?
A	Named primary institution (federal agency, peer-reviewed journal, major research centre) reporting its own figure. Attribution and finding both specific.	Yes

TIER	MEANING	SAFE TO QUOTE PUBLICLY?
B	Reputable secondary source reporting a named primary study. The primary exists and is correctly attributed; I have not read the paper itself.	Yes, if you attribute the secondary source — or spend 5 min confirming the primary
C	Industry, commercial, or aggregator figure. Methodologies differ and numbers move fast.	Only as a **range**, never as a precise fact

Before launch, personally confirm every A-tier figure you put in marketing. It takes an afternoon and it is the difference between a credible product and a liability.

= goes stale within ~12 months. Re-check each edition.

Part 1 — Evidence that the METHODS work

This is the section that matters most and that competing products do not have. Nobody has run a trial on "does a move-out guide work" — that study does not exist, and any product claiming otherwise is lying. What follows is evidence for the **specific mechanisms** the book is built on.

1.1 Planning and goal-setting

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-001	Implementation intentions ("if X, then I will do Y") improved goal attainment with medium-to-large effect, **d = 0.65** across **94 independent tests**	Gollwitzer & Sheeran, meta-analysis, Advances in Experimental Social Psychology (2006)	B
S-002	If-then plans work by specifying the when, where and how of action in advance, converting intention into initiation	Gollwitzer, implementation intentions literature	B
S-003	Implementation intentions help initiate action, shield ongoing pursuit from distraction, and support disengagement from failing approaches	Gollwitzer & Sheeran (2006)	B
S-004	Specific, difficult goals outperformed "do your best" goals in **96%** of studies synthesised over 35 years	Locke & Latham, A Theory of Goal Setting & Task Performance; American Psychologist (2002)	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-005	Within a person's ability range, goal difficulty correlates with performance at roughly **r = 0.82**; for impossible goals the correlation collapses to ~0.11	Locke & Latham	B
S-006	Goal effectiveness requires five conditions: clarity, challenge, commitment, feedback, and allowance for task complexity	Locke & Latham	B
S-007	New behaviours took a **median 66 days** to reach automaticity, range **18–254 days**, among the 48% who succeeded	Lally et al., European Journal of Social Psychology (2010), n=96	B
S-008	Missing a single day does not derail habit formation	Lally et al. (2010)	B
S-009	The "21 days to a habit" claim is not supported by the underlying research	Lally et al. (2010) and commentary	B

1.2 Saving, commitment and automation

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-010	Save More Tomorrow participants raised savings rates from **3.5% to 13.6%** over 40 months	Thaler & Benartzi, Journal of Political Economy (2004)	B
S-011	**78%** of those offered the SMarT plan joined; **80%** remained through the fourth pay raise	Thaler & Benartzi (2004)	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-012	Those given direct advice to save more immediately raised rates only 4.4% → 8.8% — roughly half the effect of the pre-commitment design	Thaler & Benartzi (2004)	B
S-013	Save More Tomorrow has been applied to more than **15 million** Americans	Benartzi, programme documentation	C
S-014	SECURE 2.0 (2022) made auto-enrolment and auto-escalation the default for most new 401(k) plans from 2025	U.S. federal legislation	A
S-015	A commitment savings account (SEED) increased savings **81%** versus control after one year, n=1,777	Ashraf, Karlan & Yin, Quarterly Journal of Economics (2006)	B
S-016	SEED worked by letting savers voluntarily restrict their own access to funds until a self-chosen goal or date	Ashraf, Karlan & Yin (2006)	B
S-017	Commitment devices address self-control problems by raising the psychological cost of accessing money	Behavioural economics literature; J-PAL summary	B
S-018	Physically segregating and visually labelling funds significantly increases saving rate	Soman & Cheema, "Earmarking and Partitioning", Journal of Marketing Research	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-019	In one field study, earmarking raised the savings rate from **0.74% to 4% of income** — a fivefold increase, same people, same income	Earmarking/ partitioning field research	B
S-020	Mental accounting: people code money into non-fungible accounts by source, use, or time period; labelling changes how money is spent	Thaler, mental accounting literature (1980s onward)	B
S-021	Partitioning plus a violable savings "rule" increases saving more than either alone	Soman & Cheema	B
S-022	Caveat: earmarking can backfire if it leads people to hold low-interest savings while carrying high-interest debt	Earmarking literature	B
S-023	Households hold stable cash-buffer targets and adjust spending to return to them after windfalls or shocks	JPMorgan Chase Institute	A
S-024	A typical middle-income household needed roughly **$4,800** in liquid assets — about 14% of post-tax annual income — to absorb normal income and spending swings	JPMorgan Chase Institute, 5.9M household sample	A
S-025	**92%** of households could cover a $400 emergency, including 77% of the lowest income quartile — but sources beyond cash savings were essential	JPMorgan Chase Institute (2024)	A

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-026	Households typically lacked sufficient liquid savings for a large expense shock occurring alongside income loss	JPMorgan Chase Institute	A

1.3 Does financial education actually change behaviour?

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-027	Meta-analysis of **76 randomised experiments**, **160,000+ individuals**, found positive causal effects of financial education on both knowledge and downstream financial behaviour	Kaiser, Lusardi, Menkhoff & Urban, Journal of Financial Economics (2022); NBER WP 27057	A
S-028	Effects were economically meaningful, comparable to educational interventions in other domains, and **at least three times larger** than earlier estimates	Kaiser et al. (2022)	A
S-029	Results held after restricting to top-journal papers, adequately powered studies, and correcting for publication bias	Kaiser et al. (2022)	A
S-030	Financial literacy is strongly associated with financial outcomes across populations	Lusardi & Mitchell, financial literacy research programme	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-031	"Just-in-time" financial education — delivered at the moment of a decision — outperforms general instruction delivered in advance	Financial capability literature	B

1.4 Checklists

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-032	A 19-item surgical safety checklist cut major complications from **11% to 7%** across eight hospitals	Haynes et al., New England Journal of Medicine (2009)	A
S-033	Inpatient death rates after major surgery fell from **1.5% to 0.8%** — a reduction of more than 40%	Haynes et al. (2009)	A
S-034	Complication reductions held after adjustment for case mix, and appeared at both high- and low-income sites	Haynes et al. (2009)	A
S-035	Checklists work by making implicit steps explicit under conditions of stress and complexity	WHO Guidelines for Safe Surgery (2009); Gawande	B

1.5 Spending psychology — including where the popular advice is wrong

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-036	In a sealed-bid auction, credit-card bidders bid **64–113% higher** than cash bidders for identical items	Prelec & Simester, "Always Leave Home Without It", Marketing Letters (2001)	B
S-037	The "pain of paying" — psychological cost of parting with money — is reduced by cards relative to cash	Prelec & Simester (2001); cashless-effect meta-analysis	B
S-038	Meta-analysis confirms a robust "cashless effect": less tangible payment methods increase spending	Cashless-effect meta-analysis, Journal of Retailing / ScienceDirect (2024)	B
S-039	**Budgeting apps that display "amount left to spend" can increase spending.** Users checking budget feedback spent significantly more than budgeted; those tracking from memory did not overspend	Think Forward Initiative / Eller College, University of Arizona	B
S-040	Spending in a budgeted category ran roughly **$30 higher** than in non-budgeted categories, controlling for usual patterns	Budgeting-app research	B
S-041	Most budgeting apps lose users within **90 days**, before behaviour change becomes habitual	Budgeting-app engagement research	C
S-042	Showing ranges rather than precise remaining balances reduced the overspending effect	Think Forward Initiative	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-043	There is no strong empirical evidence that adopting a budgeting app improves financial welfare on its own	Budgeting-app literature review	B

1.6 Income as a lever

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-044	People who negotiate salary receive on average **18.83% more** than those accepting the first offer	Aggregated 2024–25 salary negotiation studies	C
S-045	Only about **30%** of U.S. workers ask for higher pay when hired; ~55% accept the initial offer without negotiating	Salary negotiation survey data	C
S-046	In a study of ~3,858 tech candidates, those who countered won an average raise of **12.45%**, roughly $27,000/year	Salary negotiation study	C
S-047	Failing to negotiate the first job may cost **$1–1.5 million** in lifetime earnings	Babcock, Carnegie Mellon	B
S-048	Historic gender gap in first-salary negotiation: ~7% of women vs ~57% of men attempted it	Babcock, Women Don't Ask	B

Part 2 — Market and population

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-049	**25.2 million** U.S. adults under 35 lived with parents in 2025 — a record	U.S. Census via ConsumerAffairs	B
S-050	**32.5%** of adults 18–34 lived with parents (2024 ACS), up from 31.8% in 2023	U.S. Census American Community Survey	A
S-051	**20.4%** of adults 25–29 lived with parents in 2025, ~6 points above 2000	U.S. Census via Fortune	B
S-052	**18%** of adults 25–34 lived in a parent's home in 2023	Pew Research Center	A
S-053	**~70%** of 25–34-year-olds living with parents are **employed**	U.S. Census analysis via Fortune	B
S-054	Young adults' share living with parents varies widely by metro area	Pew Research Center (April 2025)	A
S-055	**40–60%** of residentially independent young adults return to the parental home **at least once**	Boomerang/failure-to-launch research, Maturitas (2015)	B
S-056	Returning home is driven by financial, social and emotional factors on both sides, not one cause	Maturitas commentary (2015)	B
S-057	Redefinition of roles and expectations is critical to whether the living arrangement succeeds	Maturitas commentary (2015)	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-058	Drivers include globalised economies, rising housing costs, and decline of entry-level low-skill jobs	Boomerang research	B
S-059	Emerging adulthood (~18–29) is a distinct developmental stage: role exploration, instability, self-focus, feeling in-between, open possibilities	Arnett, emerging adulthood theory	B
S-060	Emerging adults increasingly endorse **financial independence** as the single enduring marker of adulthood	Arnett; emerging adulthood literature	B
S-061	The two psychological capacities signifying adulthood: making one's own decisions and accepting responsibility for them	Arnett	B
S-062	Traditional 20th-century markers of adulthood were independent domicile, stable career, marriage, parenthood, financial independence	Emerging adulthood literature	B

Part 3 — Housing cost and the rental market

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-063	In 2024, **22.7 million** renter households — **49% of all renters** — spent over 30% of income on rent and utilities	Harvard Joint Center for Housing Studies, America's Rental Housing	A
S-064	**12.1 million** renter households were severely cost burdened, paying over half their income for housing	Harvard JCHS	A
S-065	Cost burdens rose in 44 states and 88 of the 100 largest metros over five years	Harvard JCHS	A
S-066	Renters earning under $30,000 had a record-low **$210** left after housing costs — down 60% from 2001	Harvard JCHS	A
S-067	Cost burden increasingly affects middle-income renters, not only the lowest earners	Harvard JCHS	A
S-068	Record cost-burdened renter numbers for a third consecutive year	National Low Income Housing Coalition	A
S-069	HUD 30% rule: housing costs above 30% of gross income = cost burdened; above 50% = severely cost burdened. Standard set **1981**	HUD USER	A

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-070	HUD's 30% threshold includes **basic utilities**, not rent alone	HUD	A
S-071	Median 1-BR rent, Aug 2026: **$1,221**	Apartment List National Rent Report	C
S-072	Median 1-BR rent, Aug 2026: **$1,545**	ApartmentAdvisor	C
S-073	Average 1-BR rent, Aug 2026: **$1,664**	Apartments.com	C
S-074	Average U.S. rent, Feb 2026: **$1,995**	Zillow Rental Manager	C
S-075	By Q4 2025 asking rents for professionally managed apartments fell 0.6% year over year	Harvard JCHS	A
S-076	Rental markets are seasonal; winter typically brings less competition than the summer peak	Rental market guides	C

Part 4 — The cost of moving out

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-077	Total upfront cost of a first solo apartment: **$3,000–$8,500**	Aggregated 2026 renter cost guides	C
S-078	Budget **3–4× monthly rent** just to sign the lease	2026 renter cost guides	C
S-079	Security deposit, 1-BR: **$1,000–$2,000**; studio **$800–$1,500**	2026 deposit survey data	C
S-080	Local professional movers **$1,000–$1,200**; DIY truck and supplies **$300–$600**	2026 moving cost guides	C
S-081	Total utility setup: **$150–$600**; plan **$300–$500**	2026 utility/ moving guides	C
S-082	Electric connection fee **$30–$100**; deposit **$100–$300** on thin or poor credit	Payless Power; ApartmentGuide	C
S-083	Gas setup **$30–$70**; deposit **$50–$150**	2026 utility guides	C
S-084	Internet installation **$0–$100**; frequently waived with self-install	2026 utility guides	C
S-085	Utility deposits are commonly **waived** for good credit or auto-pay enrolment	Utility provider guidance	C
S-086	Providers charge **$100–$400 per service** on a thin file or past late payments	Utility cost guides	C

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-087	Furnishing a first apartment: **$800–$5,000**	2026 renter cost guides	C
S-088	Application fees **$25–$75** per adult, non-refundable	Rental market norms	C

Part 5 — Qualifying for a lease

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-089	The **3× gross rent** rule is the common income standard; some landlords use 2.5×, luxury 4×	LeaseRunner; RentForms; Roadway Moving	C
S-090	Typical minimum credit score **620–670**; luxury buildings 700+	myFICO; LeaseRunner	C
S-091	On the FICO 300–850 scale, above **670** generally indicates good credit	myFICO	A
S-092	**90% of landlords** use tenant background checks compiling rental, credit, employment, income and criminal history into a simplified score	Urban Institute; PolicyLink	A
S-093	Renters are routinely denied due to **erroneous, outdated, or mismatched** records in screening reports	Urban Institute, "Opening the Black Box of Tenant Screening"	A
S-094	Screening databases struggle to match records without unique identifiers; risk profiles are sensitive to subjective matching decisions	Urban Institute	A
S-095	Criminal-record mismatches by name alone are a documented screening failure mode	National Consumer Law Center	A
S-096	False eviction records appear on tenant reports and cause wrongful denials	Consumer litigation / FCRA practice	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-097	Screening errors can lead to repeated denials or homelessness in tight markets	PolicyLink	A
S-098	Under the FCRA, denial based on a consumer report entitles you to an **adverse action notice** naming the agency, and a free copy of that report	Fair Credit Reporting Act	A
S-099	Third-party guarantor services cost roughly **70–110% of one month's rent**	TheGuarantors, Insurent, Leap and comparable	C
S-100	A **cosigner** signs the lease, is fully liable, and may occupy; a **guarantor** is liable but has no occupancy right	Rentec Direct	B
S-101	Federal Fair Housing Act prohibits discrimination on race, colour, national origin, religion, sex (incl. sexual orientation and gender identity), familial status, and disability	HUD / Fair Housing Act	A
S-102	Many states and cities add protected classes such as source of income, age, and marital status	State and municipal fair housing law	A

Part 6 — Credit from zero

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-103	CFPB estimated **26 million** U.S. adults were "credit invisible" — about 1 in 10 with no credit history at the three bureaus	CFPB Data Point: Credit Invisibles (2015)	A
S-104	A further **19 million** had credit history too stale or thin to generate a score	CFPB	A
S-105	**Correction:** in mid-2025 the CFPB disclosed a data error; corrected figures put credit invisibility at **5.8% of adults (13.5 million)** in Dec 2010. Cite the corrected figure, or cite both	CFPB technical correction (June 2025)	A
S-106	Black and Hispanic consumers are credit invisible at ~15% vs ~9% of White consumers	CFPB	A
S-107	Credit invisibility is concentrated among the young	CFPB	A
S-108	Secured card deposits typically **$200–$5,000**; deposit usually equals the credit limit	Self.inc; Capital One	C
S-109	Credit-builder loans typically **$300–$1,000 over 6–24 months**	CFPB via Capital One	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-110	CFPB 2020 research: opening a credit-builder loan, for people **without an existing loan**, raised the likelihood of having a credit score by **24%**	Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (2020)	A
S-111	Authorized-user status can add the primary account's history to your report — including its bad behaviour	Capital One; NFCC	B
S-112	Rent reporting: Esusu reports an average **+53 points** within six months across ~5 million renters	Esusu (vendor-reported)	C
S-113	TransUnion found improvements up to **~26 points** after 12 months of reported on-time rent	TransUnion	B
S-114	Experian Boost: **62%** of users saw an increase, averaging **+13 points** on FICO Score 8	Experian (vendor-reported)	C
S-115	Thin-file renters see the largest gains from rent reporting because there is more room to move	Rent reporting research	B
S-116	CFPB publishes a free "Building credit from scratch" checklist	CFPB, files.consumerfinance.gov	A
S-117	Payment history is the largest single factor in a FICO score	FICO	A
S-118	Nobody can legally remove **accurate** negative information from a credit report	FCRA; CFPB consumer guidance	A

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-119	Most negative marks age off after seven years	FCRA	A
S-120	Nonprofit credit counselling via the NFCC is free or low cost	National Foundation for Credit Counseling	A
S-121	AnnualCreditReport.com is the only federally authorised source for free reports from all three bureaus	Federal law / FTC	A

Part 7 — Leases, deposits and tenant rights

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-122	Security deposit return deadlines range **14 to 60 days** by state	Nolo; iProperty-Management	B
S-123	14-day states include HI, NE, NY, VT; 60-day states include AL, AR, WV	Nolo	B
S-124	Landlords withholding any portion generally must provide an **itemised written statement**	State deposit statutes	B
S-125	Many states impose **2×–3× penalty damages** for missing the deadline	State deposit guides	B
S-126	In HI, PA, FL, KY, MT, VT a landlord missing the deadline may forfeit the right to retain any deposit	Nolo	B
S-127	Clauses shifting maintenance and repair duty to the tenant are a documented red flag	Redfin; Avail; Atlanta Volunteer Lawyers Foundation	B
S-128	Non-refundable security deposits are illegal in some states	G3 Management; Lemonade	B
S-129	Clauses penalising tenants for contacting police, fire or health inspectors may violate public safety law	G3 Management; tenant advocacy	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-130	Cash- or wire-only rent demands are a fraud indicator	Zillow	B
S-131	Late fees exceeding local statutory caps are a red flag	Multiple tenant guides	B
S-132	Time-stamped photo and video documentation at move-in is the standard deposit protection	Zillow; Redfin; Lemonade	B
S-133	Normal wear and tear is generally the landlord's cost, not the tenant's	State landlord-tenant law	B
S-134	In most states landlords cannot contract out of habitability obligations	State landlord-tenant law	B
S-135	Some states permit "repair and deduct" or rent escrow, with strict procedural requirements	State landlord-tenant law	B
S-136	Withholding rent without following statutory procedure commonly converts a valid complaint into an eviction case	Tenant advocacy guidance	B
S-137	Many states require landlord notice before entry except in emergencies	State landlord-tenant law	B
S-138	Many states require a domestic violence lease-termination provision regardless of lease text	State law	B
S-139	A roommate agreement is not a lease but serves as written evidence in disputes, including small claims court	Tenants Union; legal templates	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-140	Joint and several liability means a landlord may pursue any one tenant for the full rent	Landlord-tenant law	B
S-141	Most roommate disputes are preventable by writing expectations down at the start	Tenants Union guidance	B
S-142	Unapproved subletting can be grounds for eviction	Landlord-tenant law	B

Part 8 — Rental fraud

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-143	Since 2020 consumers reported nearly **65,000 rental scams** totalling about **$65 million** in losses	Federal Trade Commission (Dec 2025)	A
S-144	About **half** of rental scams reported in the 12 months to June 2025 originated with a **fake Facebook ad**	FTC	A
S-145	FBI received **12,368** real estate fraud complaints in 2025, up from 9,359 in 2024; losses rose from ~$174M to over **$275M**	FBI IC3	A
S-146	Scammers copy legitimate listings and change only the contact details	FTC Consumer Advice	A
S-147	FTC guidance: search the address, reverse-image search the photos, search the owner's name with "scam"/"complaint"	FTC	A
S-148	Rent far below local market is a primary scam indicator	FTC	A

Part 9 — Living costs

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-149	USDA Thrifty food plan, single adult 19–50: **~$247–$309/month** (2026)	USDA Food Plans via grocery-budget trackers	B
S-150	USDA Low-Cost plan, single adult: **$323–$371/month**	USDA via trackers	B
S-151	The Thrifty plan assumes careful planning, bulk buying, store brands, minimal waste; it is the basis for SNAP allotments	USDA	A
S-152	Average home-cooked meal **~$4.23** vs **$16+** at an inexpensive restaurant — roughly **$12** saved per meal	Aggregated 2026 cost comparisons	C
S-153	Replacing two restaurant meals per week with home cooking saves roughly **$1,000/year** for one person	Cost comparison research	C
S-154	Renters insurance averages **~$23/month**, range **$16–$36** by state	ValuePenguin; Insurance.com	C
S-155	Benchmark policy: $40,000 personal property, $1,000 deductible, $300,000 liability	ValuePenguin	C
S-156	Renters insurance covers personal property, liability, additional living expenses, guest medical	GEICO; Nationwide; Allstate	B
S-157	**Not** covered: earthquake, flood, bedbugs, mould, and the building structure	Multiple insurers	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-158	**57%** of U.S. renters carry renters insurance, up from 42% in 2018 and 31% in 2012	Insurance Information Institute	A
S-159	BLS 2024: average household spending **$78,535**; housing $26,266; transportation $13,318; food $10,169	BLS Consumer Expenditure Survey	A
S-160	Housing plus transportation accounted for **~50%** of household spending in 2024	BLS, The Economics Daily	A
S-161	Standard emergency fund guidance: **3–6 months** of essential expenses	Wells Fargo; CNBC Select; NFCC	B
S-162	Millennial median emergency savings: **$300**	Forbes (2026)	C
S-163	Median transaction account balance under 35: **$5,400–$7,500** (all accounts, not only emergency)	Forbes / Federal Reserve Survey of Consumer Finances	B

Part 10 — Mental health and the transition

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-164	Nearly **1 in 2** adults aged 18–24 report loneliness	Washington University in St. Louis, eight-country study (2026)	A
S-165	Loneliness is associated with being younger and with **living alone**	Peer-reviewed review, PMC	B
S-166	**75%** of mental health problems emerge before age 24	Mental Health Foundation	B
S-167	Loneliness is linked to elevated depression and anxiety risk, in a reinforcing cycle	Newport Institute; PMC review	B
S-168	The mortality impact of social disconnection is comparable to smoking **up to 15 cigarettes a day** — greater than obesity or physical inactivity	U.S. Surgeon General's Advisory on Social Connection (2023)	A
S-169	Loneliness is associated with greater risk of cardiovascular disease, dementia, stroke, depression, anxiety and premature death	U.S. Surgeon General (2023)	A
S-170	The Surgeon General's finding rests on Holt-Lunstad's meta-analytic work on social connection and mortality	Holt-Lunstad, Brigham Young University	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-171	Exercise reduced depression (**SMD −0.61**) and anxiety (**SMD −0.47**); aerobic exercise showed the largest effect	Umbrella review with meta-meta-analysis	B
S-172	The **greatest** depression benefit from exercise was seen in **emerging adults aged 18–30**	Umbrella review	B
S-173	Group and supervised exercise settings produced greater depression reductions than solo exercise	Umbrella review	B
S-174	Loneliness interventions show only moderate efficacy and there is no quick fix; sustained practice is required	BMC Public Health systematic review (2023); APA	B
S-175	Interventions aimed at improving **friendship or community connection** were associated with positive outcomes	BMC Public Health systematic review	B
S-176	Recurring group participation with shared experience and accountability is a common feature of effective interventions	Loneliness intervention review	B
S-177	EAP utilisation runs roughly **5–8%** — meaning **90%+** of workers with free counselling access never use it	National Business Group on Health; EAP industry data	B
S-178	EAPs typically provide **3–8 free counselling sessions** per issue per year	EAP programme documentation; OPM	A
S-179	The most common reason employees don't use an EAP is simply not knowing it exists	EAP utilisation research	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-180	988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline: call or text 988 (US), 24/7	SAMHSA	A
S-181	National Domestic Violence Hotline: 1-800-799-7233; text START to 88788	NDVH	A
S-182	211 connects to local emergency housing, food, utility and financial assistance	United Way 211	A

Part 11 — Parents, support, and launching *(Parent Edition)*

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-183	Parents supporting adult children provide an average of **$1,384/month**	Savings.com / industry surveys (2024–25)	C
S-184	That monthly support is **more than twice** the **$609** the average working parent contributes to their own retirement	Savings.com analysis	C
S-185	**~47–50%** of parents still financially support adult children	CNBC citing Savings.com study	B
S-186	**58%** of parents said they sacrificed their own financial security for their adult children	Bankrate / industry survey	C
S-187	**61–68%** of parents with adult children have made a financial sacrifice to help them	Bankrate; PLANADVISER	C
S-188	**43%** made a retirement-savings sacrifice; **18%** described it as significant	Industry survey data	C
S-189	AARP (Nov 2025): average annual parental contribution ~**$7,000**	AARP	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-190	Nearly nine in ten parents would make further sacrifices; ~50% would draw from savings or retirement accounts; ~33% would delay retirement or take on debt	Industry survey data	C
S-191	Parental autonomy support correlates positively with child wellbeing (**r = 0.30**); psychological control correlates with ill-being (**r = 0.26**)	Self-determination theory meta-analysis across cultures	B
S-192	Autonomy-supportive parenting fosters intrinsic motivation and satisfies needs for autonomy, competence and relatedness	Self-Determination Theory (Deci & Ryan; Joussemet et al.)	B
S-193	Controlling parenting via psychological control and conditional regard increases risk of psychopathology and impairs achievement	SDT literature	B
S-194	Children of autonomy-supportive parents show more autonomous self-regulation and better achievement	Joussemet, Landry & Koestner, Canadian Psychology	B
S-195	The autonomy-support/control findings replicate cross-culturally	SDT meta-analysis	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-196	Meta-analysis of **53 studies, 111 effect sizes**: helicopter parenting associated with increased internalising behaviours and **reduced self-efficacy**, academic adjustment and regulatory skills	"Parenting in Overdrive" meta-analysis	B
S-197	Helicopter parenting associated with more depressive symptoms and reduced self-efficacy in college students	Journal of Child and Family Studies	B
S-198	Helicopter parenting associated with lower career adaptability, less in-depth exploration, and higher career self-doubt	PMC (2022)	B
S-199	**Open family communication weakened** the negative association between overparenting and environmental mastery	Overparenting research	B
S-200	Parental financial socialisation is positively associated with young adults' financial attitudes, behaviour, knowledge and wellbeing	LeBaron-Black et al., systematic review and meta-analysis, Journal of Family Theory & Review (2026)	A
S-201	Parental involvement is the single most significant factor shaping financial attitudes and behaviour	Financial socialisation literature	B

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-202	Effective parental methods include modelling, instructing, setting rules, and explicit hands-on discussion of money	Financial socialisation research	B
S-203	Adults who as children held bank accounts and had spending monitored by parents were more likely to own financial assets and hold positive money attitudes	Childhood financial socialisation research, AFCPE	B

Part 12 — Assistance programmes

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-204	LIHEAP helps with heating/cooling bills and energy-crisis emergencies; eligibility varies by state	HHS Administration for Children and Families	A
S-205	SNAP recipients automatically meet the LIHEAP income test in most states	HHS / state LIHEAP offices	A
S-206	LIHEAP emergency applications are processed within **18–48 hours** in most states	State LIHEAP programmes	B
S-207	National Energy Assistance Referral line: 1-866-674-6327	NEAR / HHS	A
S-208	SNAP is administered through state agencies; many working adults qualify without applying	USDA FNS	A
S-209	Feeding America's locator identifies local food banks; most apply no means test	Feeding America	A
S-210	Many colleges operate food pantries open to students and often alumni	Campus pantry networks	B
S-211	National Runaway Safeline (under 21): 1-800-786-2929	NRS	A
S-212	The Trevor Project (LGBTQ+ young people): 1-866-488-7386; text START to 678-678	The Trevor Project	A

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	TIER
S-213	Legal aid offices and law school clinics frequently review leases free of charge	Legal Services Corporation network	B

Part 13 — Weak or contested evidence *(cite carefully, or not at all)*

Being honest about what the evidence does **not** support is what makes the rest credible. These were checked and came back weaker than the popular claim.

ID	FINDING	SOURCE	NOTE
S-214	The link between subjective sleep quality and cognitive performance in **healthy** young adults is weaker than commonly claimed; one study found no association across working memory, executive function and procedural learning	PMC (2020), three empirical studies	**Do not** claim a good mattress improves work performance. Say it improves sleep parameters, which is what the evidence supports
S-215	Mattress research shows measurable improvement in objective sleep parameters (efficiency, onset latency) but not always in subjective sleep quality	Actigraphic mattress studies	Soften any mattress claim accordingly
S-216	Loneliness interventions have mostly been trialled on **older** adults; efficacy evidence specific to young adults is thinner	BMC Public Health review	Present young-adult advice as reasoned, not proven
S-217	Budgeting apps may increase spending — the opposite of the standard advice	Think Forward Initiative	Use this. It is a genuine differentiator

ID	FINDING	SOURCE	NOTE
S-218	The CFPB's 26-million credit-invisible figure was corrected downward in 2025	CFPB correction	Cite the correction, or you will be caught out

Citation standard

1. Every dollar figure in either edition carries a bracket reference to a row here.
2. Ranges are printed as ranges. Never collapse $3,000–$8,500 into "about $5,000."
3. State-dependent claims carry VERIFY LOCALLY. This is legal protection as much as accuracy.
4. Re-verify every row before each edition. Rent, food and survey figures go stale within 12 months, and a stale number in a paid product generates refunds.
5. **Never upgrade a tier to make marketing easier.** A C-tier industry figure quoted as though it were federal data is the fastest way to lose the credibility this library exists to build.